



NSW Education Standards Authority

--	--	--	--	--

Centre Number

--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--

Student Number

2024 HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

English Standard

Paper 1 — Texts and Human Experiences

**General
Instructions**

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 1 hour and 30 minutes
- Write using black pen
- A Stimulus Booklet is provided at the back of this paper
- Write your Centre Number and Student Number at the top of this page and page 5

**Total marks:
40****Section I – 20 marks** (pages 2–8)

- Attempt Questions 1–5
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section II – 20 marks (pages 9–11)

- Attempt Question 6
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section I

20 marks

Attempt Questions 1–5

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Read the texts on pages 2–6 of the Stimulus Booklet carefully and then answer the questions in the spaces provided. These spaces provide guidance for the expected length of response.

Your answers will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
 - analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
-

Question 1 (4 marks)

Text 1 — Poem

Explain how Brazil conveys ideas about connection.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

If you need additional space to answer Question 1 use the lines below.

.....

.....

.....

Question 2 (4 marks)**Text 2 — Prose fiction extract**

How does Morton represent the experience of change?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

If you need additional space to answer Question 2 use the lines below.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

BLANK PAGE

--	--	--	--	--

Centre Number

English Standard
Paper 1 – Texts and Human
Experiences

--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--

Student Number

Section I (continued)

Attempt Questions 3–5

Answer the questions in the spaces provided. These spaces provide guidance for the expected length of response.

Please turn over

Do NOT write in this area.

Question 3 (3 marks)

Text 3 — Nonfiction extract

How does Green invite the reader to consider aspects of the human sense of smell?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

If you need additional space to answer Question 3 use the lines below.

.....

.....

.....

.....

Question 4 (4 marks)**Text 4 — Nonfiction extract**

Analyse how Vincent connects the significance of measurement to human experience.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

If you need additional space to answer Question 4 use the lines below.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

L

[illegible]

English Standard

Paper 1 — Texts and Human Experiences

Section II

20 marks

Attempt Question 6

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question in the Section II Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
 - analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
 - organise, develop and express ideas using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context
-

Question 6 (20 marks)

In what ways has the study of your prescribed text given you insights into the complex relationship between human qualities, motivations and actions?

In your response, make close reference to your prescribed text.

The prescribed texts are listed on pages 10–11.

The prescribed texts for Section II are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Anthony Doerr, *All the Light We Cannot See*
 - Amanda Lohrey, *Vertigo*
 - George Orwell, *Nineteen Eighty-Four*
 - Favel Parrett, *Past the Shallows*
- **Poetry**
 - Rosemary Dobson, *Rosemary Dobson Collected*
The prescribed poems are:
 - * *Young Girl at a Window*
 - * *Over the Hill*
 - * *Summer's End*
 - * *The Conversation*
 - * *Cock Crow*
 - * *Amy Caroline*
 - * *Canberra Morning*
 - Kenneth Slessor, *Selected Poems*
The prescribed poems are:
 - * *Wild Grapes*
 - * *Gulliver*
 - * *Out of Time*
 - * *Vesper-Song of the Reverend Samuel Marsden*
 - * *William Street*
 - * *Beach Burial*
- **Drama**
 - Jane Harrison, *Rainbow's End*
from Vivienne Cleven et al., *Contemporary Indigenous Plays*
 - Arthur Miller, *The Crucible*
 - William Shakespeare, *The Merchant of Venice*

Section II prescribed texts continue on page 11

Section II prescribed texts (continued)

- **Nonfiction**
 - Tim Winton, *The Boy Behind the Curtain*
The prescribed chapters are:
 - * *Havoc: A Life in Accidents*
 - * *Betsy*
 - * *Twice on Sundays*
 - * *The Wait and the Flow*
 - * *In the Shadow of the Hospital*
 - * *The Demon Shark*
 - * *Barefoot in the Temple of Art*
 - Malala Yousafzai and Christina Lamb, *I am Malala*
- **Film**
 - Stephen Daldry, *Billy Elliot*
- **Media**
 - Ivan O’Mahoney, *Go Back to Where You Came From*
The prescribed episodes are:
 - * *Series 1: Episodes 1, 2 and 3*
 - and
 - * *The Response*
 - Lucy Walker, *Waste Land*

End of paper

BLANK PAGE



NSW Education Standards Authority

2024 HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

English Standard

Paper 1 — Texts and Human Experiences

Stimulus Booklet

	Page
Section I	
• Text 1 – Poem	2
• Text 2 – Prose fiction extract	3
• Text 3 – Nonfiction extract	4
• Text 4 – Nonfiction extract	5
• Text 5 – Prose fiction extract	6
• Text 6 – Photograph	6

Text 1 — Poem

of glass and wood and water

I am trying to tell you about Venice,
how I felt
waking in a crisp white room
to rain falling softly
in the courtyard
outside my window.

I want to tell you about the light in that room,
about the houseplants and the glass
and the books
in languages I couldn't read
and the bath that didn't work,
how happy I was.

I want to tell you about the colour of Venetian water
and the way the sky and sea
makes everything soft and old,
how the wood groans—
the way nothing is spoken
and everything is sung.

In Venice I walked on wet stone
through a floating cloud.
You weren't there,
so the mist kissed the back of my neck
where you would have.

EMMA BRAZIL

© With the kind permission of Emma Brazil (Author)

Text 2 — Prose fiction extract

The flight back to Australia departed late at night, and Jess had left [the house] with hours to spare; partly because she was catching the train [to the airport] and you never know what might happen, but also because, having packed and readied the house for her absence, she'd started to feel like a guest who'd overstayed her welcome and was now being tolerated by a well-mannered host. The train ride had been smooth, and she'd arrived well ahead of time, setting herself up in [a café] near security so she could have a bite to eat before going through the rigmarole^[1]. She preferred it on this side, where travellers and their families were still together. She liked to guess at their relationships and the purpose of travel, the destinations, and the length of time they'd be away.

She had been observing a group of three at a table beside her own and continued to watch them now as they made their way towards the security area. The young woman carrying a backpack was clearly the one leaving, walking faster than the older couple, with an eagerness and energy to her gait^[2]. A few metres out from the door she stopped and they all embraced; some further words were exchanged, the backpack was referenced, and a laugh was shared. Another round of hugs and the girl continued to the door alone. She gave her parents (presumably) a quick wave, flashed them a bright smile, and didn't look back again.

Jess had been that young girl once, twenty years before. She knew about the excitement on the other side of the gate: the first taste of real freedom, the thrilling sense of being, at last, in control of one's own destiny.

KATE MORTON
Homecoming

© Kate Morton

^[1] rigmarole *complicated process*

^[2] gait *walking style*

Text 3 — Nonfiction extract

Due to copyright restrictions, this material cannot be displayed until permission has been obtained.

Text 4 — Nonfiction extract

The very first measurement, like the first word or first melody, is lost to time: impossible to localise and difficult even to imagine. Yet it was a hugely significant act: another addition to that nest of primeval^[1] consciousness that grew in the brains of our ancestors hundreds of thousands of years ago, and that would eventually set us apart from the other animals of the plain. For measurement, like speech and play, is the cornerstone of cognition^[2]. It encourages us to pay attention to the boundaries of the world, to notice where the line ends and the scales tip. It requires that we compare one portion of reality to another and describe the differences, creating a scaffold for knowledge ... If we could not measure, then we could not observe the world around us; could not experiment and learn. Measurement allows us to record the past and by doing so uncover patterns that help predict the future. And finally, it is a tool of social cohesion and control, letting us coordinate individual effort into something greater than the sum of its parts. Measurement has not only made the world we live in, it has made us too.

I first began to realise the importance of measurement when writing about the redefinition of the kilogram as a journalist in 2018. I had travelled to Paris for the assignment, and there interviewed scientists who had been working on the project for decades as part of the International Bureau of Weights and Measures, the organisation that oversees the metric system. They explained how, since the eighteenth century, the kilogram had been defined as the weight of a particular lump of metal: an actual physical artefact, kept under lock and key in an underground vault in France. Every weight in the world (even the non-metric ones) could be traced back to this single standard, to *the* kilogram ...

The existence of this hidden world was a revelation. I felt like I had opened the door of my flat one morning only to step out on to the surface of an alien planet, surrounded suddenly by strange trees and the cries of unfamiliar animals. The idea that something as fundamental and commonplace as a unit of measurement was even capable of change was thrilling, and the more I learned, the more questions I had. Why is a kilogram a kilogram, anyway? Why an inch an inch? Who first decided these values and who maintains them now?

As I followed these breadcrumbs, I began to understand what an intellectual feast measurement truly is, what a banquet of historical, scientific, and sociological wonder.

JAMES VINCENT
Beyond Measure

Beyond Measure: The Hidden History of Measurement by James Vincent, Faber and Faber Ltd

^[1] primeval *ancient*

^[2] cognition *the mental processing of information*

Text 5 — Prose fiction extract

At times these days I think of the way the sun would set on the farmland around our small house in the autumn. A view of the horizon, the whole entire circle of it, if you turned, the sun setting behind you, the sky in front becoming pink and soft, then slightly blue again, as though it could not stop going on in its beauty, then the land closest to the setting sun would get dark, almost black against the orange line of horizon, but if you turn around, the land is still available to the eye with such softness, the few trees, the quiet field of cover crops already turned, and the sky lingering, lingering, then finally dark. As though the soul can be quiet for those moments.

All life amazes me.

ELIZABETH STROUT

My Name is Lucy Barton

An excerpt from *My name is Lucy Barton* © Elizabeth Strout (2016)
Used by permission of Random House - an imprint and division of Penguin Random House LLC
All rights reserved

Text 6 — Photograph



Courtesy of Florian Schroeder

BLANK PAGE

BLANK PAGE